PART J
GUIDELINES



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Introduction

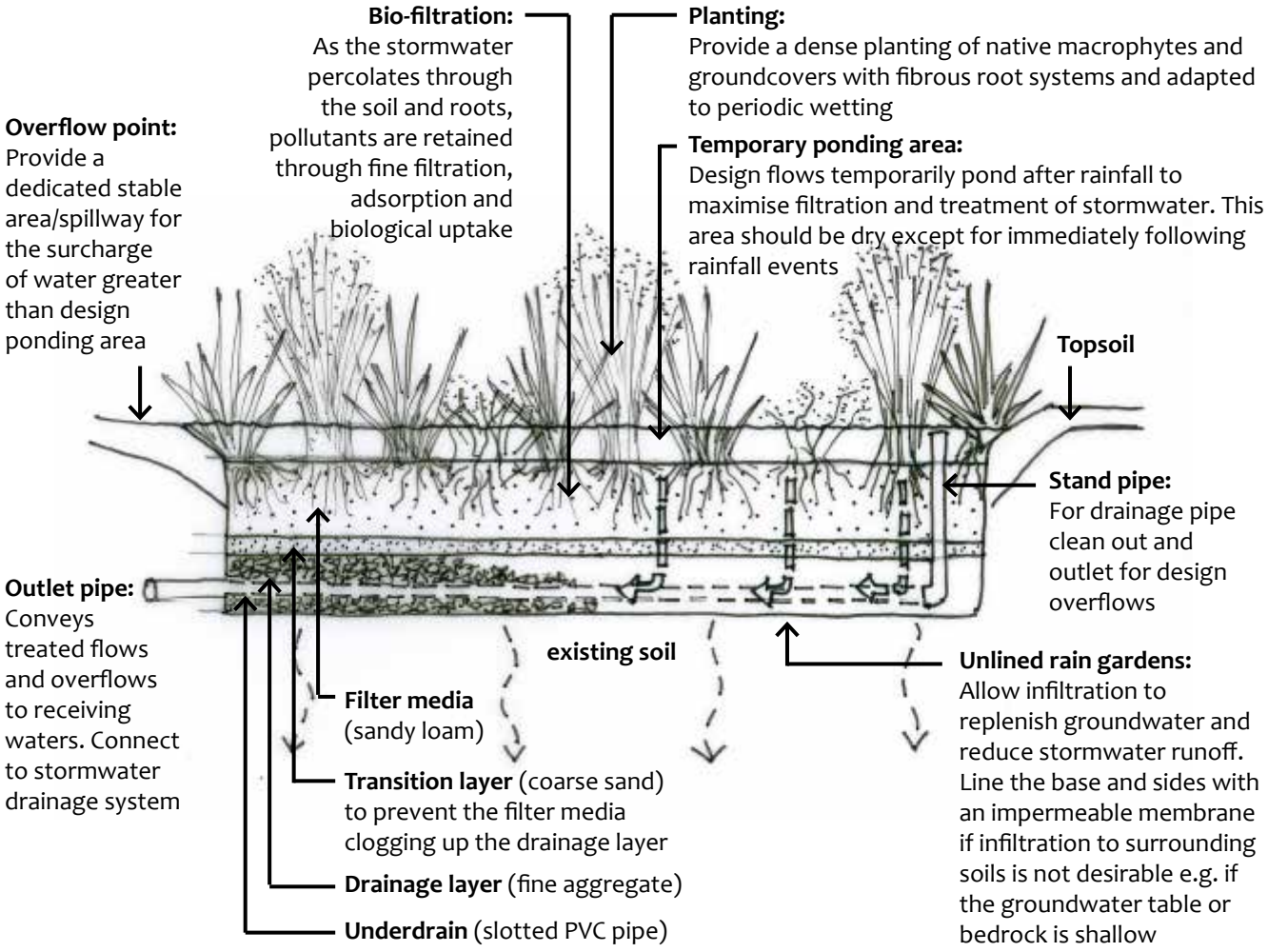
This part contains guideline documents to provide detailed advice on how to prepare certain reports or plans.

These documents are to provide guidance and do not form part of the DCP.

J1 PART C6: Typical rain garden or bio-retention system design for single dwellings and dual occupancies

Building a rain garden is a simple way to help the environment and the health of our local waterways while providing a self-watering garden for your backyard. A rain garden is a specially prepared garden designed to capture and filter stormwater run-off from impervious areas such as roofs or other hard surfaces such as driveways or paving.

A rain garden is comprised of a soil based filter (specified sandy loam material), with a sand transition layer and gravel trench underneath that contains a slotted drain pipe (ag pipe) that is connected to the drainage system. A typical system (looking through the side of the filter) is shown below.



Part J1 - Figure 1: Typical rain garden system.

Typical design criteria for a rain garden or bio-retention system to be used in a single dwelling or dual occupancy development are as follows:

(a) Rain gardens may be any shape provided the filter area is at least 2% of the contributing impervious area catchment. For example, a 400 square metre impervious area catchment would require an 8 square metre rain garden. The 8 square metre system could be 4m long and 2m wide, or 8m long and 1m wide, or any other combination that gives 8 square metres in surface area.

(b) All rain gardens (except systems with the side and base lined with an impermeable membrane) should be set back from the boundary by 4m.

(c) Provide adequate setbacks to any underground services (gas, electricity, water, on-site effluent disposal systems) and to the foundations of existing buildings and structures.

(d) Rain gardens should be positioned to treat as much of the site's impervious area runoff (from roof downpipes, rain tank overflows, driveway, paved areas) as possible.

(e) Minimum Design Criteria are as follows:

- The temporary ponding area should be at least 200mm deep.
- Filter media should be sandy loam and be between 200-400mm depth.
- Transition layer should be coarse sand and be approximately100mm depth.
- Drainage layer should be gravel and be at least 200mm depth.
- The perforated collection pipe or underdrain should be at least 90mm in diameter and be connected to the stormwater drainage system.

(f) Infiltration from the base of the drainage layer of a rain garden is recommended to be provided where ever this can be safely accommodated by the site and environmental conditions (soil depth and permeability, depth to groundwater table or bedrock).

(g) Where rain gardens are located near shallow groundwater or bedrock, or where soils of low permeability occur, the base and sides must be lined with an impervious membrane to prevent infiltration.

(h) Provide suitable collection and disposal of design overflows to a stormwater drainage system (street gutter, inter-allotment drainage system or drainage easement), unless these overflows can be otherwise safely infiltrated within the site.

(i) Rain gardens should be densely planted with native macrophyte or groundcover species that:

- are adapted to the local climatic conditions and high and variable nutrient and moisture conditions; and

- contain extensive fibrous root systems, spreading rhizomatous or suckering habitat are preferred over a clumped habit; and
- are established at a minimum density of at least 8 plants per square metre across the filter area base and any side batters; and
- provide complexity and year round coverage by including at least 4 different species within the filter area, use mainly moisture tolerant species such as *Juncus planifolius*, *Juncus usitatus*, *Carex appressa*, *Gahnia*, *Lepidosperma*, *Schoenus* and *Restio* species. Other species that may be incorporated are *Poa sieberiana*, *Lomandra*, *Patersonia, Dianella* and *Blechnum* species or other similar local native species.

Note: For further information consult www.melbournewater.com.au/building-and-works/stormwater-management/options-treating-stormwater/raingardens. The plant species suggested in this information need to be modified to be compatible with local Blue Mountains conditions.

J2 PART C6: Water Sensitive Urban Design (WSUD) guidelines for large scale development

The WSUD strategy and stormwater management system is to be appropriately designed and sized in a manner consistent with the latest guidelines and current best management practices for WSUD

The latest WSUD guidelines include but are not limited to:

(a) Using MUSIC in Sydney's Drinking Water Catchment A WaterNSW Current Recommended Practice (2023) by WaterNSW (for use in Sydney's Drinking Water Catchments) (www.waternsw.com.au/__data/assets/pdf_file/0020/58250/Using-MUSIC-in-the-Sydney-Drinking-Water-Catchment.pdf)

(b) Concept Design Guidelines for WSUD by Water by Design SEQ Version 1.1 April 2010 (waterbydesign.com.au/download/concept-design-guidelines-for-water-sensitive-urban-design)

(c) Construction and Establishment Guidelines by Water by Design SEQ Version 1.1 April 2010 (waterbydesign.com.au/download/wsud-construction-guidelines)

(d) Water Sensitive Urban Design – Technical Design Guidelines for South East Queensland, by Water by Design SEQ 2006 (waterbydesign.com.au/download/water-sensitive-urban-design-technical-design-guidelines-forsouth-east-queensland)

(e) Maintaining Vegetated Stormwater Assets by Water by Design SEQ 2012 (waterbydesign.com.au/download/maintaining-vegetated-assets)

(f) Adoption Guidelines for Stormwater Biofiltration Systems (Version 2) by the Cooperative Research Centre for Water Sensitive Cities, 2015 (watersensitivecities.org.au/content/stormwater-biofilter-design/)

(g) Australian Runoff Quality - A Guide to Water Sensitive Urban Design by Engineers Australia, 2006 (www.engineersaustralia.org.au/sites/default/files/Learned%20Society/Resources-Guidelines%26Practice%20notes/Australian_Runoff_Quality-Guide_to_WSUD.pdf)

(h) WSUD Engineering Procedures Stormwater by Melbourne Water dated 2005 (www.publish.csiro.au/book/4974)

(i) Managing Urban Stormwater: Harvesting and Reuse by the NSW Department of Environment and Conservation, 2006 (www.environment.nsw.gov.au/publications/managing-urban-stormwater-harvesting-and-reuse)

(j) Developments in Sydney's Drinking Water Catchment – Water Quality Information Requirements by WaterNSW (as relevant to the Sydney Drinking Water Catchment). (www.waternsw.com.au/__data/assets/pdf_file/0008/134747/Developments-in-the-Sydney-Drinking-Water-Catchment.pdf)

(k) Water Sensitive Design Guide for Rural Residential Subdivisions, Water Sensitive Urban Design (www.waternsw.com.au/__data/assets/pdf_file/0003/56478/Water-Sensitive-Design-Guide-for-Rural-Residential-Subdivisions.pdf);

(l) Section 10 and WSUD drawings in the Western Sydney Engineering Design Manual (www.bmcc.nsw.gov.au/sites/default/files/docs/WesternSydneyEngineeringDesignManual_Oct2022.pdf)

Note: These documents provides relevant general technical guidance however may include stormwater treatment targets or other criteria that are different to targets required by Blue Mountains City Council).

J3 PART C6: Typical WSUD devices

The WSUD strategy is to include a treatment train that is to comprise all necessary stormwater treatment devices, to provide the retention, filtering, infiltration and safe disposal necessary to meet the required stormwater treatment performance outcomes.

The WSUD strategy is to include appropriate water quality and quantity treatment devices, such as:

(a) Rainwater tanks and reuse

(b) Grey water treatment and tanks for re-use

(c) Detention basins

(d) Sediment basins

(e) Gross pollutant capture devices

(f) Oil/grit/grease/water separators

(g) Vegetated filter strips

(h) Grass or vegetated swales

(i) Bio-retention swales or basins

(j) Sand filter beds

(k) Porous pavements

(l) Infiltration measures

(m) Constructed wetlands

Note - Adaptability to climate change should be considered in the planning, design and management of WSUD strategies and infrastructure, particularly with regard to long term stormwater harvesting schemes and landscaping species selection. Consider potential changes in the volume and frequency of rainfall, temperatures and other climatic conditions, bushfire and storm recurrence and intensity and ecological succession.

J4 PART D: Heritage Listings

Clause 5.10 (heritage conservation) of LEP 2015 provides for the protection of the heritage of the Blue Mountains. Heritage items and heritage conservation areas are identified by property address and real property description in Schedule 5 of LEP 2015 and also on the accompanying Heritage maps. Refer also to Part L1 *Heritage Contributions Maps* for the contributory value of each property within a heritage conservation area. The contributions are identified as contributory, neutral or uncharacteristic. Heritage listings are based on studies carried out by qualified heritage consultants engaged by Council, and heritage listing has been the result of a rigorous approval process.

All items on Schedule 5 of LEP 2015 are listed as being of local heritage significance; however, a number of items are also assessed as being of state significance, meaning they have significance and value to the broader community of NSW. Some of these items with state-significant assessments have been formally listed on the State Heritage Register. The listing status (whether local or state) is identified in Schedule 5 of the LEP.

Individual heritage inventory sheets have been prepared for each heritage item and heritage conservation area. These provide background information about the history of the property or area, a description of the item or area and an assessment of the various heritage values. These heritage inventory sheets should be referred to early in the development process. They are also required to be considered when preparing a heritage management document for submission to Council with a development application. These inventory sheets are available from Council and on the NSW Heritage Branch's website at www.hms.heritage.nsw.gov.au/App/Item/SearchHeritageItems?_ga=2.165972984.714120821.1658117920-344545924.1656901875. The information in the heritage inventory sheets will be considered by Council as part of its assessment of development applications.

J4.1 Understanding a property's significance

Individual heritage inventory sheets have been prepared for each heritage item and heritage conservation area. These provide background information about the history of the property or area, a description of the item or area and an assessment of the various heritage values. These heritage inventory sheets should be referred to early in the development process. They are also required to be considered when preparing a heritage management document for submission to Council with a development application. These inventory sheets are available from Council and on the NSW Heritage Branch's website at www.hms.heritage.nsw.gov.au/App/Item/SearchHeritageItems?_ga=2.165972984.714120821.1658117920-344545924.1656901875. The information in the heritage inventory sheets will be considered by Council as part of its assessment of development applications.

There are a number of ways to determine the heritage significance of heritage items and conservation areas.

J4.2 Heritage inventory sheets

Search for the property's heritage inventory sheet on the Heritage Council website. Properties within heritage conservation areas will not be separately listed, so the search should be for the name of the heritage conservation area.

Research and investigation is an ongoing process, and some inventory sheets may appear incomplete; however, this does not mean that the property is not significant.

J4.3 Researching property history

Without clear information from a heritage inventory sheet, additional research may be required. The purpose of undertaking research into a property's history is to assist Council in considering how the proposed development has taken into account the history and significant features of the item. Important or relevant information could include:

Historical details: dates, architects/builders, period of subdivision, names of any significant original or early owners, significant previous uses or associations

Heritage significance: any previous assessments of significance

Intactness and condition: an analysis of materials and elements to establish original, early and later fabric and details; to identify later or new elements; to identify the condition of important elements

Braemar, Springwood: Local Studies Library

Council has a Local Studies Library that contains records, photographs and other archival and historic material that may be of relevance in preparing information in support of proposed changes to heritage properties. The librarian at the Library should be contacted for assistance.

Conservation and heritage community groups

There are a number of local community-based conservation and heritage groups who can provide information and guidance.

J4.4 Records search

Council's records may contain useful information on file which can be accessed by a GIPA search. This is a free service provided by Council, following the submission of the application form, which can be found here: www.bmcc.nsw.gov.au/access-to-information/how-do-i-get-information-from-council. File material may contain previous heritage assessments, approvals and consent conditions, old photos and other material useful in understanding the history of the site.

J4.5 Heritage assessment guidelines

The Office of Environment and Heritage (OEH) provides free publications to assist owners, local Councils, consultants and others in understanding heritage significance. A primary document is 'Assessing Heritage Significance' which is available to download at www.environment.nsw.gov.au/publications/assessing-heritage-significance

A list of heritage practitioners can be found on the website of the Office of Environment and Heritage (OEH) at www.environment.nsw.gov.au/topics/heritage/manage-heritage-items

J4.6 Guidelines

- The Burra Charter: The Australia ICOMOS Charter for Places of Cultural Significance, 1999

This part of the DCP is consistent with the Australian International Council on Monuments and Sites (ICOMOS) Charter for the Conservation of Places of Cultural Significance (The Burra Charter). The Burra Charter is available on Council's website.

- The Conservation Plan, by James Semple Kerr, National Trust, 2000

This seminal text sets out the format for and is a guide to the preparation of Conservation Plans. Available as a free download on the NSW Heritage Branch website at australia.icomos.org/publications/the-conservation-plan/

- Heritage Branch publications

The Heritage Branch provides a diverse range of publications covering many heritage and conservation topics: technical advice, conservation by of particular building types, heritage nominations, assessing significance, thematic histories, and more. Many are available free to download.

Also available is Design in Context, guidelines for infill development, and New Uses for Heritage Places, publications prepared in association with the Australian Institute of Architects, and available as free downloads. The Heritage Branch of NSW publications are available at www.environment.nsw.gov.au/research-and-publications/publications?sort=field_publish_event_date

- State Environmental Planning Policy (Exempt and Complying Development) 2008

The 'Codes SEPP' details exemptions for a range of minor works for heritage items and within heritage conservation areas. It also allows complying development within conservation areas but does not allow complying development to heritage items.

J5 PART E5: Crime Prevention Through Environmental Design (CPTED) Guidelines

J5.1 Site building layout

Orientate the main entrance towards the street or both streets if located on a corner.

Offset windows, doorways and balconies to allow for natural observation while protecting privacy.

Avoid large trees, carports, skillion extensions, fences or downpipes next to second storey windows or balconies that could provide a means of access.

Design balconies and windows to maximise natural observation of vehicle and pedestrian movement.

Set buildings back from the verge to create a perception of semi-private space.

J5.2 Entrances and building identification

Locate entrances in prominent positions.

Use design features such as numbering and directional signage so that entrances are easily recognisable.

Providing common access points to no more than 6 to 8 dwellings.

Where buildings accommodate a number of dwellings or uses, the building entry should clearly state the dwelling numbers accessed from that entry.

Include a viewing window/vision panel in fire exit doors to allow visibility before opening. (The materials must comply with the fire rating requirements of the Building Code of Australia.)

Staff entrances that are separate from the main entrance must be located to maximise opportunities for natural surveillance from the street or other public areas.

Locate offices, desks, work-stations so as to overlook public areas, carparking areas, entrances to buildings, adjoining arcades, malls and the like.

Place street numbers so they are clearly visible and not obscured by foliage.

J5.3 Blind corners

Design direct pathways.

Make sure that any barriers along pathways are visually permeable ('see through'), including landscaping and fencing.

Install glass panels in stairwells to maximise visibility.

Use mirrors so that users can see around corners or ahead of them.

J5.4 Lighting

Use diffused lights and/or movement sensitive lights.

Direct these lights towards access/egress routes to illuminate potential offenders, rather than towards buildings or resident observation points.

Lighting should have a wide beam of illumination, which reaches to the beam of the next light, or the perimeter of the site or area being traversed.

Avoid light spillage onto neighbouring properties as this can cause nuisance and reduce opportunities for casual surveillance.

Light areas to enable users to identify a persons face 15 metres away.

Lighting of all pathways, areas adjoining public spaces and outdoor/open carparking areas is to be in accordance with Australian/ New Zealand Standard 1158.3.1:1999 – Pedestrian Area Lighting.

Illuminate possible places for intruders to hide, including letterboxes and communal areas.

Use energy efficient lamps, fittings and switches to save energy.

Ensure that external areas such as letterboxes and communal areas are well lit and observable from inside.

Ensure that entrances to buildings are well illuminated.

J5.5 Communal/public areas

Position active uses or habitable rooms with windows adjacent to main communal/ public areas, such as playgrounds, swimming pools, gardens, car parks, etc.. Whilst natural surveillance is encouraged in this instance, consideration also needs to be given to acoustic impacts on habitable areas. A balance needs to be sought.

Make sure utility/service areas are easily secured, well lit and free of possible entrapment spots such as alcoves. For aesthetic reasons, garbage storage areas should be screened from public places using fencing or vegetation. Careful and innovative design is required to balance both of these design criteria.

Open style or transparent materials are encouraged on doors and/or walls where stairwell or elevators are provided.

Waiting areas and entries to elevators/stairwells should be close to areas of active uses and should be visible from the building entry.

Seating should be located in areas of active uses.

J5.6 Ownership

Distinguish dwellings or groups of dwellings by using design features such as colour, vegetation, paving, fencing, furniture etc.

Physical and/or psychological barriers, such as fences, gardens, lawn strips, varying textured surfaces can be used to define different spaces and to clearly distinguish between public, semi public-private and private spaces.

J5.7 Landscaping

Avoid medium-height vegetation with concentrated top to bottom foliage. Plants such as low hedges and shrubs, creepers, ground covers and high canopied vegetation are good for natural surveillance.

Trees with dense low growth foliage should be spaced or 'crown raised' to avoid a continuous barrier.

When landscaping around children's play areas, car parks and along pedestrian pathways, use low ground covers or high canopied trees which have clean (i.e.., free of foliage) trunks to a minimum height of 2 metres.

Where planting is provided within 5 metres of a pedestrian pathway, it should be lower than 1 metre or be thin trunked with a high canopy.

Keep a cleared space of 3 to 5 metres on either side of pathways and bicycle routes. Step back vegetation in height beyond this point.

Planting should not prevent informal surveillance by adjacent residents.

Avoid vegetation which conceals the building entrance from the street.

Prickly plants may be used as effective barriers, where appropriate.

Landscaping techniques can be used to prevent access to windows and walls for better security and graffiti management.

J5.8 Fences

Fences should not inhibit surveillance of communal areas, pathways and footpath by occupants of the building. Both the height of the fence in relation to the building, as well as the nature of the construction materials needs to be considered.

Keep fences and walls low and/or open to improve observation and maximise sunlight. Vegetation should not obscure building entrances, windows and other vulnerable areas.

Install double glazing where noise is a problem at the front of the building rather than using a high solid fence.

Use light coloured open fencing, if privacy is an issue, as this will provide more privacy than dark coloured open fencing, but will still allow a level of surveillance from the street.

Colourbond fences should not be used as a fencing material adjoining public open space or thoroughfare unless vegetation is planted in front to reduce graffiti access.

J5.9 Security

Door and window locks should be installed in accordance with the relevant Australian Standard in all residential developments comprising three or more dwellings and in commercial and industrial developments.

Display security system notices prominently.

Ensure that perimeter doors and windows are of solid construction and fitted with quality deadlocking devices.

Fit the main entry doors with viewing ports to allow identification of visitors.

Install sensor lighting or timed lighting that can be controlled from within the building.

Encourage casual use of public and semi-private open spaces during evening hours so they can be 'animated' with legitimate activities.

J5.10 Building materials

Use toughened or laminated glass at ground floor level.

Modulate large walls and use dark colours to discourage graffiti.

Consider the use of vegetation such as 'creepers' on walls or the use of murals which can be effective in deterring graffiti.

Use strong, wear-resistant laminate, impervious glazed ceramics, treated masonry products, stainless steel materials or use anti-graffiti paint or clear over sprays.

Avoid flat or porous finishes where graffiti is likely to be a problem.

Ensure that skylights and roofing tiles cannot be easily removed from the outside.

Glass should be reinforced with shatter resistant material to prevent entry.

J5.11 Public facilities

Employ traffic calming measure to slow cars and encourage pedestrian activity where possible.

Locate public facilities in highly visible locations that are well lit and near activities with extended trading hours such as restaurants, convenience stores, taxi ranks, etc..

Locate public facilities away from possible entrapment spots such as fire exits, alleys, etc..

Design ATM's to incorporate mirrors or reflective materials so that users can observe people behind. Do not locate ATM's in alcoves which limit visibility.

Provide directional signs to key services and landmarks such as railway stations, police stations, taxi ranks, etc.

Design pedestrian pathways to be of generous width in busy areas.

Construction of pathways through existing vegetation should consider the appropriateness of the route, the need to thin vegetation at the base of trees and to the location and orientation of lighting.

Design open spaces so that they are clearly designated and easily observed by people. Parks and playgrounds should face the street rather than lanes and be placed in close proximity to public activity (such as in front of a building, shopping centre).

Play equipment, seating, BBQ areas and the like, should be provided to encourage active use of these areas.

Seating should be conveniently located and easily seen.

Facilities such as toilets and telephones should be located close to areas of active uses.

Bus and taxi shelters are to be located within close proximity to active areas (street, pathways, adjoining businesses, etc..). Vegetation surrounding such shelters should be minimised or maintained to maximise visibility. Shelters should be well lit.

Pathways should be direct, follow pedestrian sight lines and avoid blind corners. Avoid sudden changes of grade on pathways, where possible, if it reduces sight lines.

Directional and behavioural signage should be provided at entrances to parks / open space areas.

J5.12 Car parking facilities

Avoid large expanses of car parks. If this is not possible provide surveillance such as security cameras (in accordance with the NSW Government policy, statement and guidelines for the 'Establishment and Implementation of CCTV in Public Places').

Access to lifts, stairwells and pedestrian pathways should be clearly visible.

Pedestrian sight lines should be clearly identified to direct users to exits or key points within the car park facility such as the use of lighting, pavement markings, etc..

Locate disabled parking spaces in highly visible and convenient locations.

Locate car parks in areas that can be observed by adjoining uses.

Minimise the number of entry and exit points. Where possible, locate entry/exit points in proximity to active uses such as shops.

Staff parking facilities should be separated, secured (where appropriate), well lit and easily accessible.

Internal car park structure (such as concrete columns, solid internal walls, service rooms and enclosed fire exits) can create significant visual obstructions in car parks. Adequate sight lines are to be provided and design alternatives such as minimising vertical columns through engineering design or placing 'portholes' in car park walls increases visibility.

Avoid the use of the 'herring-bone' configuration in open car parking areas where possible, as this restricts natural supervision and limits sight lines.

J6 PART E5: Food Safety Guidelines

All food businesses are required to satisfy the following key food safety requirements:

J6.1 Approval requirements

The relevant approvals must be obtained from Council prior to commencing the operation and use of any food business.

J6.2 Food premises fit-out

Food premises must be designed and constructed in accordance with specific standards and requirements to facilitate cleaning, good food-handling practices, health and hygiene and to minimise potential contamination and food-borne illnesses as set out in the Food Safety Code and Australian Standard 4674 – 2004 Design, construction and fit-out of food premises.

J6.3 Food handlers: skills and knowledge

All food handlers must have the necessary skills and knowledge in food safety and food hygiene.

The operator or manager of the business must have high-level skills and knowledge in food safety and food hygiene and they must ensure that all staff have sufficient knowledge and skills in food safety.

Council recommends that all food handlers undertake formal training in food safety and food hygiene, such as relevant TAFE or food/catering college training course. At least one food safety supervisor must be appointed for each venue within a business.

J6.4 Food handling practices and controls

The operator or manager of the business and all food handlers must ensure that food products are handled in a safe and controlled manner, from transportation, receipt, storage, processing, display, service and disposal.

Incorrect or sloppy food-handling practices significantly increase the risk of food becoming contaminated and causing potentially serious food poisoning incidents.

Food must be stored, prepared, displayed and handled in a way that does not increase the risk of contamination or the growth of bacteria and toxins.

Standard 3.2.2 of the Food Standards Code contains detailed requirements and procedures for food handling.

J6.5 Temperature control

To minimise the risk of food spoilage, food poisoning and the growth of bacteria or toxins, it is essential that potentially hazardous food is kept under appropriate temperature control.

Potentially hazardous food includes:

- raw and cooked meat or poultry, or foods containing meat or poultry, e.g. casseroles, curries, meat pies, sausage rolls, kebabs, lasagne, spaghetti bolognese
- dairy products, e.g. milk, custard, cream, dairy based desserts
- seafood, e.g. fish, prawns, lobsters, oysters, calamari, shellfish
- processed fruits and vegetables, e.g. salads
- cooked rice, pasta and pasta salads
- foods containing eggs, beans, nuts or other protein rich foods, e.g. quiche, soy products
- foods that contain these foods, e.g. sandwiches and rolls.

Potentially hazardous food must be maintained:

- at or below 5°C (i.e. in a refrigerator or freezer), or
- at or above 60°C (i.e. in a heated display cabinet).

Potentially hazardous food should be cooled from 60°C to 21°C within 2 hours and 21°C to 5°C within a further 4 hours, and be refrigerated as soon as practicable (generally within 2 to 4 hours).

All refrigerators, freezers and heated food display cabinets must be monitored with an accurate thermometer (can be located within the appliance where readily visible), to ensure that food is maintained within the appropriate temperature range (e.g. digital-probe type thermometer).

Standard 3.2.2 of the Food Standards Code details the specific requirements for keeping potentially hazardous food at appropriate temperatures.

J6.6 Prevention of contamination

Food business operators must ensure that all practicable measures are taken to protect food from the likelihood of contamination.

Food contamination can be caused by a number of inappropriate practices and controls, including:

- inappropriate temperature control
- inappropriate thawing and re-heating practices
- vermin and pests (e.g. mice, rats, flies, cockroaches, birds, insects)
- unclean equipment, appliances, utensils and surfaces
- unclean hands and clothing

- cross contamination of food, between raw food and cooked/ready to eat food
- incorrect or poor food-handling practices (e.g. from touching cooked/ready-to-eat food without gloves)
- contamination from customers (e.g. handling or sneezing upon the food)
- poor transportation and storage practices
- poor cleaning and person hygiene practices
- inappropriate or insufficient waste disposal facilities
- other physical and chemical contamination

Raw foods (e.g. meat, chicken, seafood) must be stored, prepared and processed separately or away from ready-to-eat cooked food to prevent possible cross contamination of food.

Standard 3.2.2 of the Food Standards Code contains further details and requirements to prevent contamination of food.

J6.7 Cleaning and sanitising

It is essential that food premises are kept in a clean condition at all times including all walls, floors, ceilings, shelving, windows, cooking equipment, ventilation equipment, fridges, appliances, cupboards, utensils, crockery, cutlery, furniture and fittings.

The most effective and efficient way of keeping the premises clean and hygienic is to develop and implement an ongoing cleaning program.

The cleaning program should identify who, what, when and how the particular area or items will be cleaned.

To ensure that surfaces, equipment and utensils etc. are thoroughly cleaned and sanitised, it is recommended that specific commercial 'cleaning and sanitising' products be used from a commercial kitchen, catering or cleaning supplier, in accordance with the manufacturers directions.

J6.8 Health and hygiene

Everyone is a potential carrier of bacteria and bacteria can easily be transferred from someone's hands, clothing and utensils or other articles to the food, or to the surfaces of food preparation areas or utensils.

All staff must wash their hands regularly (with warm water and hand cleanser), especially:

- before starting work
- before starting work after a break
- after handling money and before handling food
- after handling dirty dishes, glasses or utensils

- after doing any cleaning
- after using the toilet
- after smoking
- before handling cooked food - after handling raw food
- after handling rubbish or other waste
- after touching their hair, mouth, nose or any other body part.

It is also important that food handlers minimise potential contamination of food. For example, by wearing gloves or using tongs to avoid touching ready-to-eat or cooked food, and by wearing clean clothing and footwear.

J6.9 Food storage and waste disposal

Food products must be stored in an appropriate location, in a suitable container and at a controlled temperature, to prevent potential contamination and growth of bacteria.

Potentially hazardous food should be stored in appropriate plastic containers with lids, to reduce the risk of contamination from other food (e.g. to separate raw food and cooked or ready-to-eat food), and from food handling, dirt, dust and other physical and chemical contaminants.

To minimise the growth of bacteria:

- keep the food cold (below 5°C)
- keep the food hot (above 60°C)
- always re-heat and cool food quickly.

To reduce the risk of contamination, all food premises must also have sufficient and appropriate waste disposal facilities and receptacles.

Waste bins must be provided with lids and be located in a suitable area, so as not to potentially contaminate any food, other surfaces or equipment.

Food storage and waste storage areas must be kept in a clean and sanitary condition, free from vermin, flies, cockroaches and other pests.

Food businesses must arrange for their waste materials and recycling to be collected and disposed of by an approved trade/commercial waste contractor (Council's Trade Waste Service or a private licensed contractor).

J7 Current environmental guides and strategies

The Council has produced a number of environmental guides and strategies to provide detailed advice on how to prepare submissions as part of a development application and to further explain provisions within development control plans.

Included here are the following guidelines:

- Flora and Fauna Assessment;
- Vegetation Management Plan;
- Waste Management Strategy